

SYED HAMZA AREES

Junior DevOps / DevSecOps Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security-first Junior DevOps / DevSecOps Engineer with internship-based hands-on experience in Linux administration, CI/CD automation, cloud-native deployments, and infrastructure hardening. Skilled in bridging modern cloud operations with cybersecurity research, including Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) and Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC). Demonstrated ability to automate enterprise workflows, strengthen Linux server security, and improve deployment efficiency through Jenkins, Docker, and GitOps methodologies. Rapid learner with strong analytical thinking and production-focused engineering capabilities across AWS and modern DevOps ecosystems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Linux Administration: RHEL, CentOS, Ubuntu, SELinux, AppArmor, Systemd, SSH Hardening, LVM, FirewallD, IPTables, Bash Scripting, Kernel Patch Management

DevOps & CI/CD: Jenkins (Pipeline-as-Code, Groovy Shared Libraries), Docker, Docker Compose, Nginx Reverse Proxy, Git, GitHub, GitOps, Agile

Deployment & Automation: GitHub-to-Vercel Continuous Deployment (CI/CD), Serverless Email Integration (EmailJS), Next.js, TypeScript, AI-Assisted Development Workflows

Security: Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA), Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC), ML-KEM (Kyber), NIST FIPS 203, Infrastructure Hardening

Cloud & Monitoring: AWS, Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, ArgoCD, Kubernetes (EKS), Terraform, Ansible (Active Upskilling)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineering Intern

2025 – 2026 (6 Months)

AI Nafi Cloud (Remote) — Ontario, Canada

- Designed and maintained Jenkins Pipeline-as-Code workflows using Groovy scripting for automated CI/CD delivery.
- Developed reusable Jenkins Shared Libraries to standardize deployment automation across multiple projects.
- Reduced deployment execution time by approximately 40% through pipeline optimization and automation enhancements.
- Integrated containerized workflows using Docker for consistent development and staging environments; collaborated with development teams in Agile environments.

Linux System Administration Intern

2024 – 2025 (6 Months)

AI Nafi Cloud (Remote) — Ontario, Canada

- Managed enterprise Linux servers across RHEL, CentOS, and Ubuntu environments with focus on security and stability.
- Performed Linux hardening using SSH key-based authentication, firewall policies, SELinux controls, and service restrictions.
- Maintained 99.9% server uptime through proactive monitoring, patch management, and troubleshooting.
- Configured LVM partitions and storage optimization; automated administrative tasks using Bash scripting to reduce manual workload by 30%.

EDUCATION

Bachelor in Artificial Intelligence Operations (Level 6 – UK) — Graduated 2025

EduQual, United Kingdom

ENGINEERING & AUTOMATION PROJECTS

Portfolio Website — AI-Assisted CI/CD Deployment Pipeline

- Built and shipped a production Next.js/TypeScript portfolio site, version-controlled on GitHub and continuously deployed via GitHub-to-Vercel CI/CD, with EmailJS for serverless contact-form email delivery.
- Used AI-assisted development workflows to accelerate build-out while maintaining production-quality, typed, component-based code.

Cloud-Native Security Research: Zero Trust & Quantum-Safe Cryptography (Conceptual/Research Project)

- Conducted research on enterprise adoption of Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC) and Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) for cloud-native environments.
- Studied lattice-based cryptographic models including ML-KEM (Kyber) aligned with NIST FIPS 203 migration frameworks.
- Designed architectural security blueprints for hybrid cloud focusing on identity-centric access controls and micro-segmentation strategies.
- Explored AI-driven anomaly detection models for adaptive threat monitoring and behavioral analysis.

Wanderlust Mega Project — MERN on AWS EKS (Team Collaboration)

- Deployed an enterprise-grade MERN application on AWS EKS using GitOps workflows with ArgoCD for automated Kubernetes deployments.
- Integrated Prometheus and Grafana for observability; participated in peer code reviews and Agile planning sessions.

Flask-Nginx-MySQL 3-Tier Application

- Developed and deployed a containerized 3-tier application using Flask, Nginx, and MySQL with Docker Compose orchestration.
- Implemented Nginx reverse proxy for secure application routing; improved deployment portability using containerized workflows.

Jenkins Shared Libraries Automation

- Engineered reusable Groovy Shared Libraries for Jenkins to standardize CI/CD logic and reduce repetitive pipeline configurations across multiple projects.

CORE COMPETENCIES

DevOps & DevSecOps Mindset • Analytical Thinking • Team Synergy & Collaboration • Agile Problem Solving • Infrastructure Security • CI/CD Automation • Cloud-Native Architecture • Security Research & Innovation • Rapid Technology Acquisition